

EMEA-LATAM Economic Insights

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SUMMARY

Hiring weakened across EMEA-LATAM in January (-12.2% YoY on average), remaining well below pre-pandemic levels, with resilience in the UAE and Israel but sharp declines in Brazil and Mexico. Candidate activity softened across most countries, even as remote roles continued to expand and attract disproportionate demand. Hiring remains macro-led, with entry-level hiring showing slightly greater resilience, while AI is primarily influencing skill requirements within roles rather than aggregate hiring; more in our latest [AI Labour Market Update](#).

JANUARY HIRING FELL BY -12.2% YOY IN EMEA-LATAM ON AVERAGE, WITH THE UAE AND ISRAEL BUCKING THE TREND.

- Year-over-year hiring in January dropped by -12.2% on average in EMEA-LATAM, and remained significantly below pre-pandemic levels, down by -22.4% compared to a pre-pandemic January 2020.
- Hiring in the Middle East showed resilience: up 3.2% YoY in the UAE, with the largest hiring increases in Entertainment Providers (up 28.1% YoY) and Real Estate and Equipment Rental Services (up 25.8% YoY), and up 0.9% YoY in Israel.
- Hiring in LATAM fell significantly in January: down -17.4% YoY in Brazil and -20.6% YoY in Mexico.
- Green shoots were seen across several industries in Ireland despite overall hiring dropping by -7.2% YoY. The largest increases were in Entertainment Providers (up 13.1% YoY); Financial Services (5.9%); and Hospitals and Health Care (5.4%).
- Most countries showed softer demand with declines in job postings per applicant, with the largest declines in Germany (down -17.2% YoY), the Netherlands (-13.0%), and Italy (-9.8%). Counter to this we saw signs of candidate fatigue as applications per applicant continued to fall in most countries, with the largest drops in activity in the UK (down -10.5% YoY), France (-7.5%), and Germany (-5.1%).

REMOTE WORK OPPORTUNITIES GAINED MOMENTUM IN JANUARY, UP 18.7% YOY ON AVERAGE IN EMEA.

- Hybrid work remains the most common flexible work option offered by companies, with 29.2% of EMEA job postings offered as hybrid on average, led by the UK (36.2% of job postings) and Israel (35.7%).
- Remote opportunities gained momentum in January, up 18.7% YoY, with the largest shares of remote job postings offered in Ireland (10.9%), the UK (9.9%), and Germany (7.4%).
- Remote roles continue to be in high demand, making up 14.0% of applications compared to a 6.0% share of job postings. The highest shares of applications were in Germany (20.8%) and Ireland (18.5%).

OUR LATEST EDITION OF THE [AI LABOUR MARKET UPDATE](#) SHOWS HOW AI IS RESHAPING SKILLS, TALENT FLOWS, AND INFRASTRUCTURE ACROSS MAJOR ECONOMIES.

- Hiring remains macro-led. In the US, post-pandemic pullbacks and broader economic conditions explain most of the hiring variation since 2022, with the LinkedIn Hiring Rate 23% below pre-pandemic levels in 2025. While the broader market experienced a slowdown, entry-level hiring proved slightly more resilient, averaging 3 percentage points above manager and senior-level hiring over the last two years.
- AI exposure does not yet translate into divergent hiring outcomes. Augmented occupations that combine AI-replicable tasks with human skills, such as Data Analyst and Web Developer, outperformed overall hiring in 2025, closing the year at +2.8% YoY. Meanwhile, insulated and disrupted roles followed similar trajectories with sluggish hiring.
- AI Agents were the fastest-growing AI engineering skill of 2025, reflecting a shift toward autonomous execution for certain tasks. We also saw fast growth in AI Strategy and Large Language Model Operations (LLMOps), underscoring companies' growing investment in specialised workflows.

- Demand for AI engineering skills is growing unevenly across markets. While the UK (+37%) and India (+54%) saw significant YoY growth in job postings requiring AI engineering skills, demand has levelled off in France and Germany. However, AI engineering talent has retained a mobility premium: due to highly portable skills they are 8x more likely to move across borders than the average LinkedIn member.

METHODOLOGY

- The LinkedIn Hiring Rate (LHR) is a measure of hires divided by LinkedIn membership in the country. This is based on members' profile updates using the start date of a new job. The hiring rate has been seasonally adjusted, as detailed in the [LinkedIn Hiring Rate methodology](#). This number is indexed to the average month in 2016; for example, an index of 1.05 indicates a hiring rate that is 5% higher than the average month in 2016.
- Labour market tightness is calculated from the ratio of active job listings (open listings) that attract applicants (has at least one application) to the number of job seekers who applied to such listings.
- Job search intensity is the average number of job applications per applicant, measuring the intensity of each applicant's job search where job applicants and job postings share the same country. The higher the number, the more intense the job seeking behaviour of the applicant.
- A "remote job" refers to jobs that can be done completely out of the office and is defined as either the job poster explicitly labelled it as "remote" or if the job contained keywords like "work from home" in the listing. A "hybrid job" refers to jobs that are done both in the office and out of the office and is defined as being explicitly labelled as "hybrid" by job poster. The share of hybrid and remote jobs is calculated in proportion to all paid job postings.

APPENDIX

Table 1. % change in hiring

January 2026 (seasonally adjusted)

	Jan 2026	YoY % change
United Arab Emirates	1.44	3.2
Israel	1.24	0.9
Ireland	0.94	-7.2
United Kingdom	0.84	-10.1
Spain	0.83	-13.8
Sweden	0.70	-14.5
Germany	0.98	-15.6
Italy	0.85	-16.3
Netherlands	0.69	-16.8
Brazil	1.61	-17.4
France	0.85	-17.7
Mexico	0.85	-20.6

Table 2. % change in hiring by industry (YoY growth)

January 2026 (seasonally adjusted)

Industry		Jan 2026	YoY % change
United Arab Emirates	Entertainment Providers	1.66	28.1
United Arab Emirates	Real Estate and Equipment Rental Services	4.34	25.8
Ireland	Entertainment Providers	0.97	13.1
United Arab Emirates	Education	1.97	11.5
United Arab Emirates	Retail	1.60	10.8
United Arab Emirates	Professional Services	1.29	9.0
United Arab Emirates	Financial Services	1.48	7.4
United Arab Emirates	Technology, Information and Media	1.22	7.2
Ireland	Financial Services	0.83	5.9
Israel	Financial Services	1.52	5.9
Ireland	Hospitals and Health Care	1.59	5.4
United Arab Emirates	Government Administration	1.39	5.3
Ireland	Retail	1.15	5.2
Ireland	Utilities	1.66	4.0
Mexico	Oil, Gas, and Mining	0.87	3.6
Ireland	Construction	1.6	3.1
United Arab Emirates	Construction	1.8	3.0
Israel	Professional Services	1.04	2.9
United Arab Emirates	Transportation, Logistics, Supply Chain and Storage	1.44	2.4
United Arab Emirates	Consumer Services	1.65	1.4
United Arab Emirates	Accommodation and Food Services	1.46	1.3
Ireland	Wholesale	0.81	1.1
Italy	Entertainment Providers	0.8	0.2

Table 3. Labour market tightness and job search intensity

January 2026

	Job Postings per Applicant		Applications per Applicant	
		YoY % change		YoY % change
Ireland		1.0		-0.9
United Arab Emirates		-2.8		-0.1
United Kingdom		-5.4		-10.5
Brazil		-6.3		3.5
Mexico		-7.7		2.0
France		-8.5		-7.5
Italy		-9.8		0.3
Netherlands		-13.0		-2.1
Germany		-17.2		-5.1

Table 4. Share (%) of hybrid job postings

January 2026

	Jan 2026	YoY % change	MoM % change
United Kingdom	36.2	2.5	9.5
Israel	35.7	-11.2	0.8
Ireland	34.2	-6.0	16.6
Sweden	30.4	-6.5	-1.1
Netherlands	28.2	1.5	3.1
Germany	27.6	-6.9	-2.0
France	25.8	-2.7	1.1
Italy	25.3	-2.7	-3.2
United Arab Emirates	19.8	-14.3	-6.6

Table 5. Share (%) of hybrid job applications

January 2026

	Jan 2026	YoY % change	MoM % change
United Kingdom	41.1	-1.0	1.5
Israel	40.7	-6.0	1.4
Netherlands	37.4	-1.9	-0.6
Ireland	36.4	-2.1	3.0
Germany	33.4	-3.1	1.0
Sweden	31.3	-4.2	-1.3
Italy	29.2	-1.4	-0.1
France	29.1	-8.1	2.0
United Arab Emirates	8.9	-13.5	3.6

Table 6. Share (%) of remote job postings

January 2026

	Jan 2026	YoY % change	MoM % change
Ireland	10.9	11.0	-56.3
United Kingdom	9.9	18.7	-17.5
Germany	7.4	14.7	-2.2
Italy	6.5	10.6	3.3
Sweden	4.8	37.1	28.0
United Arab Emirates	4.3	48.7	18.5
France	4.0	2.8	1.8
Israel	3.1	-6.9	-32.9
Netherlands	3.0	31.6	-11.0

Table 7. Share (%) of remote job applications

January 2026

	Jan 2026	YoY % change	MoM % change
Germany	20.8	-1.4	-0.2
Ireland	18.5	-11.8	-14.0
United Kingdom	17.3	-8.9	-0.4
Italy	13.4	6.7	-0.3
Netherlands	13.1	-1.1	1.9
Sweden	12.0	3.4	5.4
Israel	8.7	-2.7	-4.7
France	8.1	3.6	-0.3
United Arab Emirates	6.0	-2.4	2.3